

PrimeFocus

September 2026



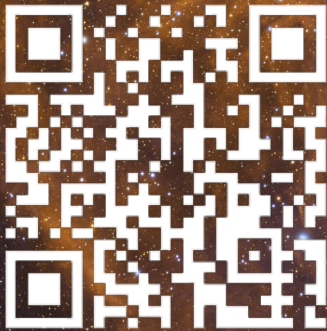
WHEN

September 18, 2026
Doors open at 7:00pm
Meeting starts at 7:30pm
Lecture starts at 8:00pm

WHERE

Unitarian Church
1893 North Vasco Road
Livermore, CA 945571
and via Zoom

TVS QR CODE



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THIS MONTH'S SPEAKER

Anecdotes of Recent Eclipses **All who attempted watching...**

So this month's meeting topic was the result of Gert's solar eclipse travels and the upcoming lunar eclipse. The lunar eclipse was going to be visible in CA so it'd be a chance for us to be creative.

We know that Gert was successful and he'll show images and describe his adventure but the lunar activity here was mostly a bust. However, If you did attempt to observe the local eclipse we still want to hear from you.

In preparation send text and images to Ron (programs@trivalleystargazers.org) so we can get a presentation assembled. And share your experiences at the meeting too.

This is a community effort so share if you attempted to watch either eclipse.

2026 Total Solar Eclipse

This composite image shows the progression of a total solar eclipse over San Millán de los Caballeros, Spain, on Wednesday, Aug. 12, 2026. A total solar eclipse swept across parts of Greenland, Iceland, northern Russia, the Atlantic Ocean, Spain, and a small corner of Portugal. A partial eclipse was visible in parts of the U.S., most of Canada, much of Europe, and northwest Africa.

Image Credit: NASA/Bill Ingalls

NEWS AND NOTES

Meeting Dates

Club Meeting	Board Meeting	PrimeFocus Deadline
September 18	September 21	September 5
October 16	October 19	October 3
November 20	November 23	November 7

Money Matters

As of the last Treasurer's Report on 6/22/26, our club's account balance is \$52,242.60, this includes \$14,205.46 in the H2O Rebuild fund.

TVS Welcomes New Members

TVS welcomes new members Alexis Martin, Cassandra Maldini, Carl Crum, Carter Crum, Muralimanohar Chepuri, Thomas Kulp, Ernesto Martinez, Selwyn Desouza, Ross Douglas, Stephen Cartwright, Rebecca Whittaker, Roger Morin, Robert Fenger, and Marc Stearman. Please say hello and chat with them during our meetings.

2026 TVS Club Star Party Schedule

Save the dates for the 2025 Club Star Parties.

Del Valle star parties are also public outreach events. They are jointly hosted with the EBRPD and held at the Arroyo Staging Area (Coords: 37.6196638, -121.7528899). The public is invited for the first 1.5-2 hours, while club members can stay the remainder of the night.

No events currently scheduled for Del Valle.

Tesla Vintners star parties are open to only club members and their guests. These star parties end at midnight, but participants can leave earlier, should they wish.

October 3: Tesla Vintner's Star Party, 5143 Tesla Rd., Livermore. Set-up at 6:15pm, Observing 6:45pm-11-59pm.

H2O Open House star parties are open to only club members and their guests. The open house ends at midnight, and all participants are encouraged to stay the duration. The drive to H2O takes about 1 hour, and the caravan leaves promptly from the corner of Mines and Tesla Rds. No gas stations are available on the route, so be prepared. Admission is \$3/car-bring exact change. H2O is a primitive site with two porta-potties. Bring water, food, and warm clothing, as needed. Red flashlights are to be used so observers can preserve their night vision.

No events currently scheduled for H2O

October 9: Outreach Event at Murray Elementary School, 8435 Davona Dr, Dublin. Set-up 6:15pm, Observing from 6:45-9:00pm.

October 12: Outreach event at John Green Elementary, 3300 Antone Way, Dublin. Set-up 6:00pm, Observing from 6:30-9:00pm

CALENDAR OF EVENTS



September 18, 19, 25,26, October 2, 3, 9,10, 16, 17, 7:30-10:30pm

What	Free Telescope Viewing
Who	Chabot Staff
Where	Chabot Space and Science Center, 10000 Skyline Blvd. Oakland, CA 94619
Cost	Free

Join Chabot astronomers on the Observatory Deck for a free telescope viewing! Weather permitting, this is a chance to explore stars, planets and more through Chabot's historic telescopes. Chabot's three large historic telescopes offer a unique way to experience the awe and wonder of the Universe. Three observatory domes house the Center's 8-inch (Leah, 1883) and 20-inch (Rachel, 1916) refracting telescopes, along with a 36-inch reflecting telescope (Nellie, 2003).

Are the skies clear for viewing tonight? Viewing can be impacted by rain, clouds, humidity and other weather conditions. Conditions can be unique to Chabot because of its unique location in Joaquin Miller Park. Before your visit, check out the Weather Station to see the current conditions at Chabot.

For more information, see
<https://chabotspace.org/events/events-listing/>
<https://eastbayastro.org/chabot-telescope-status/>

October 7, 2026, 7:00pm

What	Finding Earth 2.0 OutThere
Who	Silicon Valley Astronomy Lecture Series
Where	Smithwick Theater at Foothill College
Cost	Free

For thousands of years, we've wondered if the Earth is unique, or if there are other Earths out there to find. In just the last 30 years, we've progressed from merely wondering if planets exist around other stars to knowing that almost every star we see has planets. Ambitious planet searches have been probing further and further, finding planetary systems of an incredible – and incredibly surprising! – variety. However, we have yet

to discover another planet that might be like Earth – a rocky planet orbiting just the right distance from a Sun-like star to have liquid water on its surface. NASA has a audacious new plan for a next-generation flagship telescope that will directly image Earth-like planets around nearby stars, but it will take all of our ingenuity and technical prowess to achieve this feat. Dr Christiansen will walk you through the past, present, and future of our hunt for Earth 2.0.

Dr. Jessie Christiansen (CalTech/IPAC) is the Chief Scientist of the NASA Exoplanet Science Institute and a TED fellow. She has worked on NASA's Kepler, K2, and TESS missions, searching the sky for exoplanets, and is helping plan for NASA's next big flagship missions - the Nancy Grace Roman Space Telescope, and the Habitable Worlds Observatory. Dr. Christiansen's research is in the detection and characterization of exoplanets - planets around other stars - and studies of exoplanet populations. She is married to fellow astronomer, Philip Hopkins, and also wrangles eleven-year-old twins, two cats, and a dog in their house in the foothills of Los Angeles.

IMPORTANT NOTE: As of the Fall of 2026, the college will again charge for parking in its parking lots. Please read and follow the instructions on the signs, or feel free to pre-pay the \$3 fee by registering [here](#) (check out the more detailed [instructions](#)).

PrimeFocus

TVS ASTROPHOTOGRAPHY



NGC-6914-Reflection Nebula by Mark Hai Du



Sh2_284 foraxx by Kevin McLoughlin



WHATS UP

Adapted from Sky and Telescope

All times are Pacific Standard Time

September 2026

18	Fri	Moon at first quarter
21	Mon	Algol shines at minimum brightness for two hours centered around 11:24 pm
22	Tue	First Day of Autumn
24	Thu	Algol shines at minimum brightness for two hours centered around 8:22 pm
26	Sat	Full Moon
30	Wed	In the evening looking east-northeast see the Moon trailing the Pleiades by $5\frac{1}{2}^\circ$

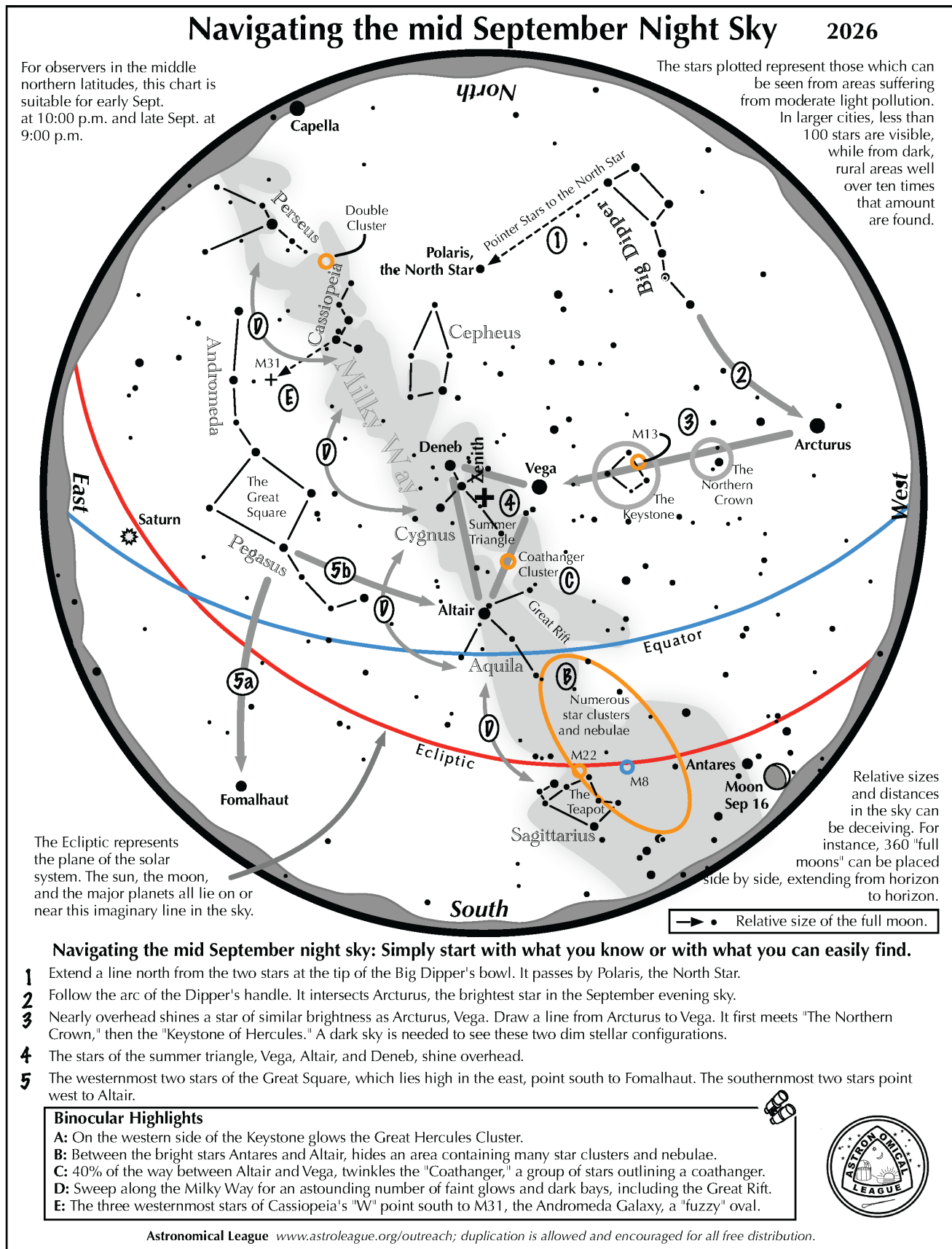
October 2026

3	Sat	Moon at third quarter
3-4	Sat-Sun	All night see Saturn at opposition
4	Sun	At dawn looking east-southeast, Pollux is $3\frac{1}{2}^\circ$ upper left of the Moon with Mars and Jupiter extending in a line toward the horizon
5	Mon	With a pair of binoculars, look east-southeast at dawn to see moon near M44, the Beehive Cluster in Cancer
10	Sat	New Moon
14	Wed	Algol shines at minimum brightness for two hours centered around 10:03 pm

OFFICERS AND VOLUNTEER POSITIONS

Officers	Volunteer Positions	Newsletter	Potluck Coordinator
President Eric Dueltgen president@trivalleystargazers.org	Astronomical League Rep. Don Dossa alrep@trivalleystargazers.org	Scott Schneider (Editor) newsletter@trivalleystargazers.org	OPEN potluck@trivalleystargazers.org
Vice-President Aris Pope vice_president@trivalleystargazers.org	Club Star Party Coordinator Tom Dossa coordinator@trivalleystargazers.org	Webmaster Swaroop Shere webmaster@trivalleystargazers.org	Program Coordinator Ron Kane programs@trivalleystargazers.org
Treasurer Ernest Epley treasurer@trivalleystargazers.org	Del Valle Coordinator Dave Wiltzius delvalle@trivalleystargazers.org	Night Sky Network Rep. Ross Gaunt nnsn@trivalleystargazers.org	Publicity and Fundraising OPEN publicity@trivalleystargazers.org
Secretary Dave Lackey secretary@trivalleystargazers.org	Historian OPEN historian@trivalleystargazers.org	H2O Observatory Director / Rebuild Chairman Chuck Grant H2O@trivalleystargazers.org	Refreshment Coordinator OPEN
Past President Ron Kane past_president@trivalleystargazers.org	Librarian Ron Kane librarian@trivalleystargazers.org	Observing Program Coordinator Ron Kane awards@trivalleystargazers.org	Web and Email www.trivalleystargazers.org info@trivalleystargazers.org
	Loaner Scope Manager Ron Kane telescopes@trivalleystargazers.org	Outreach Coordinator Tom Dossa outreach@trivalleystargazers.org	TVS E-Group To Join the TVS E-Group just send an email to TVS at info@trivalleystargazers.org asking to join the group. Make sure you specify the email address you want to use to read and post to the group.

NAVIGATING THE NIGHT SKY FOR SEPTEMBER 2026





Tri-Valley Stargazers
P.O. Box 2476
Livermore, CA 94551
www.trivalleystargazers.org

Tri-Valley Stargazers Membership Application

Contact information:

Name: _____ Phone: _____

Street Address: _____

City, State, Zip: _____

Email Address: _____

Status (select one): _____ New member _____ Renewing or returning member

Membership category (select one): Membership term is for one calendar year, January through December.

_____ Student member (\$10). Must be a full-time high-school or college student.

_____ Regular member (\$30).

Hidden Hill Observatory Access (optional): Must be 18 or older.

_____ One-time key deposit (\$20). This is a refundable deposit for a key to H2O. New key holders must first hear an orientation lecture and sign a usage agreement form before using the observing site.

_____ Annual access fee (\$10). You must also be a key holder to access the site.

Donation (optional):

_____ Tax-deductible contribution to Tri-Valley Stargazers

Total enclosed: \$ _____

Member agrees to hold Tri-Valley Stargazers, and any cooperating organizations or landowners, harmless from all claims of liability for any injury or loss sustained at a TVS function. TVS will not share information with anyone except as detailed in our Privacy Policy (<http://www.trivalleystargazers.org/privacy.shtml>).

Mail this completed form along with a check to: Tri-Valley Stargazers, P.O. Box 2476, Livermore, CA 94551.